



UNIVERSITY OF
CENTRAL FLORIDA

HUM 2020 - Encountering the Humanities Section: B063

College of Arts and Humanities
Department of Philosophy

Course Information

Term: Summer 2026

Class Meeting Days: ASC

Class Meeting Location: Online

Modality: WW

Credit Hours: 3.00

Instructor Information

Brooke Rudow

Title: Assistant Professor of Philosophy and Humanities

Office Location: PSY 229

Office Hours:

Online, M: 10am

Email: laura.rudow@ucf.edu

Course Description

HUM 2020 CAH-PHILOSOPHY 3(3,0)Encountering the Humanities: In this course, students will learn about the creative ideas and accomplishments of various cultures in various fields of humanities that may include art, architecture, drama, history, music, literature, philosophy, and religion. The course will include cultural expressions from the Western canon and may also include expressions from around the globe. Student Learning Outcomes: Students will demonstrate knowledge of arts and ideas and synthesize information from various sources. Students will analyze and

interpret selected expressions of arts and ideas. Students will compare and contrast selected expressions of arts and ideas. Students will identify contextual influences on the development of interdisciplinary arts and ideas. Fall, Spr, Sum

In this course we will discover the humanities with the sea as our theme. We begin with the Greeks. Surrounded by the sea, they set the stage and initiated Western culture as we now know it. Moving across the ocean, we will encounter people's experiences of the ocean, songs, folklore, and literature.

This course is a state core (black diamond) course in the Humanities Foundation.

General Education Program (GEP)



UCF's General Education Program (GEP) provides a cohesive learning experience across five key areas. Each course is designed to help students build essential skills and knowledge that connect across disciplines, preparing them for success in their academic, civic, and professional lives. This foundation equips students to make informed decisions and navigate a rapidly changing world.

Specifically, the GEP is intentionally designed to:

- Introduce students to a broad range of foundational knowledge.
- Provide students the opportunity to explore potential academic majors, minors, and careers.
- Equip students with the analytic and expressive skills required to engage in chosen pursuits.
- Develop critical thinking skills.
- Encourage lifelong learning.

Student Learning Outcomes

After successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

- Students will demonstrate knowledge of arts and ideas and synthesize information from various sources.
- Students will analyze and interpret selected expressions of arts and ideas.
- Students will compare and contrast selected expressions of arts and ideas.
- Students will identify contextual influences on the development of interdisciplinary arts and ideas.

Required Course Materials and Resources

All materials will be provided on Webcourses

Course Assessment and Grading Procedure

1. Participation (20%):

- Participation is determined by overall regularity of submitting assignments, responding to peers when assigned, and commenting on lecture videos.

2. Annotations (30%)

Each student will annotate required readings on the integrated Webcourses annotation tool (in Assignments). Annotations are **due each week**. Two (2) annotation grades will be dropped. In these annotations, you will:

- Highlight and summarize key points in the reading (**required**)
- Raise critical questions or discussion questions (**required**)
- Highlight significant quotes, **stating why** you like the quotes (**required**)

- Highlight words you don't know, look them up, and type out the definitions (**required**)
- Highlight quotes of things you disagree with, **stating why** you disagree (recommended)
- Offer related reflections on personal experience, beliefs, current events, or examples from the media (recommended)
- Connect reading material for this week with previous material studied in the course (recommended)

***NOTE: Doing the required minimum does not constitute A-level work. More and consistent engagement, better grade.**

3. Class Activities (20%)

There will be various class activities (discussion posts, presentations, film responses, etc.) to complete throughout the term.

4. Exams (30%)

Each week will conclude with multiple-choice/short answer exams. These are cumulative.

Grading Scale

Grading Scale	
Letter Grade	Percentage
A	94-100%
A-	90-93%
B+	87-89%
B	84-86%
B-	80-83%
C+	77-79%
C	74-76%
C-	70-73%
D+	67-69%
D	64-66%
D-	61-63%
F	0-60%

Communication Expectations

Email or Webcourse messages are fine. Allow 24-48 hours for a response on weekdays. I generally do not respond on weekends.

Policies for Course Grade

Makeup Work Policy

Activities and Exams can be made up without penalty only if the student has given me **advanced notice** that they will be missing it. The student must work with me **prior to the assignment date** to schedule an alternate time to complete the assignment.

Missed/Late Assignments

If a student misses an assignment for an unexcused reason or without notice, it is up to my discretion whether to allow the student to complete the assignment. I will use the following considerations in deciding: length of time between missing the assignment and reaching out to me, reason for missing class, prior performance in class, how many previous assignments were missed (among others).

Make-up Assignments for Authorized University Event or Co-curricular Activities

Students who represent the university at an authorized event or activity (for example, student athletes) and who are unable to meet a course deadline due to a conflict with that event must provide the instructor with documentation in advance to arrange a make-up. No penalty will be applied if the student gives advance notice and communicates with the instructor following UCF policy. In the case of an authorized university activity, it is your responsibility to show the instructor a signed copy of the Program Verification Form for which you will be absent, prior to the class in which the absence occurs or due date you need extended. For more information, see [UCF Policy 4-401](#).

Make-up Assignments for Religious Observances

A student who desires to observe a religious holy day of his or her religious faith must notify their instructor as soon as practicable prior to the observance. Students who are absent because of religious observances will be permitted a reasonable amount of time to complete any missed work. For more information, see [UCF Regulation 5-020](#).

Artificial Intelligence (AI) Use Policy

Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) is prohibited. Use of GenAI tools via website, app, or any other access, is not permitted in this class. All components of assignments in this course must be independently and originally completed by the student. Representing work created by GenAI as your own work will be treated as plagiarism.

Disability Access & Accommodations

The University of Central Florida is committed to providing equal access to all students with disabilities (ADHD, learning disabilities, Autism, chronic medical conditions, physical disabilities, etc.). To receive consideration for reasonable disability-related course accommodations, disabled students must contact Student Accessibility Services (SAS) and complete the steps required for SAS to review accommodation requests. More information can be found on the UCF [Student Accessibility Services](#) website under the Start Here tab or by contacting SAS directly (Ferrell Commons 185; sas@ucf.edu; Phone - 407-823-2371).

Approved accommodations are shared with course instructors via the SAS Course Accessibility Letter. Implementing certain accommodations may require discussion and specific considerations of the course design, course learning objectives, and the individual academic and course challenges experienced by the student. While students with disabilities or chronic health needs are also encouraged to discuss any course concerns with professors in addition to contacting SAS, professors are not required to facilitate disability-related adjustments to the course unless the

professor has received a Course Accessibility Letter from SAS that outlines approved accommodations.

Academic Integrity

Students should familiarize themselves with UCF's Code of Conduct at [Student Conduct and Integrity Office](#). According to Section 1, "Academic Misconduct," students are prohibited from engaging in:

- a. Academic misconduct is defined as any submitted work or behavior that obstructs the instructor of record's ability to accurately assess the student's understanding or completion of the course materials or degree requirements (e.g., assignment, quiz, and/or exam). Examples of academic misconduct include but are not limited to: plagiarism, unauthorized assistance to complete an academic exercise; unauthorized communication with others during an examination, course assignment, or project; falsifying or misrepresenting academic work; providing misleading information to create a personal advantage to complete course/degree requirements; or multiple submission(s) of academic work without permission of the instructor of record.
- b. Any student who knowingly helps another violate academic behavior standards is also in violation of the standards.
- c. Commercial Use of Academic Material. Selling of course material to another person and/or uploading course material to a third-party vendor without authorization or without the express written permission of the University and the instructor of record. Course materials include but are not limited to class notes, the instructor of record's slide deck, tests, quizzes, labs, instruction sheets, homework, study guides, and handouts.
- d. Soliciting assistance with academic coursework and/or degree requirements. The solicitation of assistance with an assignment, lab, quiz, test, paper, etc., without authorization of the instructor of record or designee is prohibited. This includes but is not limited to asking for answers to a quiz, trading answers, or offering to pay another to complete an assignment. It is considered Academic Misconduct to

solicit assistance with academic coursework and/or degree requirements, even if the solicitation did not yield actual assistance (for example, if there was no response to the solicitation).

Responses to Academic Dishonesty, Plagiarism, or Cheating

Students should also familiarize themselves with the procedures for academic misconduct in UCF's student handbook, *The Golden Rule*. UCF faculty members have a responsibility for students' education and the value of a UCF degree, and so seek to prevent unethical behavior and respond to academic misconduct when necessary. Penalties for violating rules, policies, and instructions within this course can range from a zero on the exercise to an "F" letter grade in the course. In addition, an Academic Misconduct report could be filed with the Office of Student Conduct and Academic Integrity, which could lead to disciplinary warning, disciplinary probation, or deferred suspension or separation from the University through suspension, dismissal, or expulsion with the addition of a "Z" designation on one's transcript.

Being found in violation of academic conduct standards could result in a student having to disclose such behavior on a graduate school application, being removed from a leadership position within a student organization, the recipient of scholarships, participation in University activities such as study abroad, internships, etc.

Title IX

Title IX prohibits sex discrimination, including sexual misconduct, sexual violence, sexual harassment, and retaliation. If you or someone you know has been harassed or assaulted, you can find resources available to support the victim, including confidential resources and information concerning reporting options at [Let's Be Clear](#) and [UCF Cares](#).

For more information on access and community engagement, Title IX, accessibility, or UCF's complaint processes contact:

- Title IX – ONAC – [Office of Nondiscrimination & Accommodations Compliance](#) & askanadvocate@ucf.edu

- Disability Accommodation – Student Accessibility Services – [Student Accessibility Services & sas@ucf.edu](#)
- [Access and Community Engagement](#) (including the Ginsberg Center for Inclusion and Community Engagement, Military and Veteran Student Success, and HSI Initiatives)
- UCF Compliance and Ethics Office – [Compliance, Ethics, and Risk Office & complianceandethics@ucf.edu](#)
- The [Ombuds Office](#) is a safe place to discuss concerns.

Reporting an Incident or Issue

If you believe you have experienced discrimination by any faculty or staff member, contact the Office of Nondiscrimination & Accommodations Compliance via the [ONAC website](#) or at 407-823-1336. You can also choose to report using the UCF Integrity Line either anonymously or as yourself at 1-855-877-6049 or by using the [online form](#). UCF cares about you and takes every report seriously. For more information see the [Reporting an Incident or Issue Webpage](#).

Deployed Active-Duty Military Students

Students who are deployed active duty military and/or National Guard personnel and require accommodation should contact their instructors as soon as possible after the semester begins and/or after they receive notification of deployment to make related arrangements.

Campus Safety

At UCF Public Safety and Police, safety is the top priority. Emergencies on campus are rare, but if one should arise, it's important to be familiar with some basic safety and security concepts.

- In an emergency, always dial 911.
- Every UCF classroom has an **Emergency Procedure Guide** posted on a wall near the door, which will show you how to respond to a variety of situations. This guide can also be found online [here](#).
- In the event of an active threat, remember **AVOID, DENY, DEFEND**. Choose the best course of action and act immediately. Watch the video [here](#) to learn more.
 - **AVOID.** Pay attention to your surroundings and have an exit plan. Get as much distance and as many barriers between you and the threat as quickly as possible.

- **DENY.** When avoiding is difficult or impossible, deny the threat access to you and your space. Lockdown by creating barriers, turning the lights off and remaining quiet and out of sight. Make sure your cell phone is silenced, but do not turn it off.
- **DEFEND.** When you are unable to put distance between yourself and the threat, be prepared to protect yourself. Commit to your actions, be aggressive and do not fight fairly. Do whatever it takes to survive.
- For emergencies on campus, UCF will utilize the [UCF Alert](#) system. All UCF students, faculty and staff are automatically enrolled to receive these email and text alerts, however, it's a good idea to frequently ensure your [contact information is up to date](#).

Financial Aid Accountability

All instructors/faculty are required to document students' academic activity at the beginning of each course. In order to document that you began this course, please complete this activity by the end of the first week of classes or as soon as possible after adding the course. Failure to do so may result in a delay in the disbursement of your financial aid.

Class Schedule

Course Schedule	
Week	Topic
1	Greeks and the Sea
2	The Middle Passage
3	Sea Shanties, Stories, and Selkies
4	Literature and the Sea
5	Hawaii, Surfing, and Nature Sports
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